PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

# Aarong

## *Brand Positioning & Social Media Growth Strategy for a Heritage Lifestyle Retailer*

Market research | Customer psychology | Positioning | Meta Ads funnel

NATIONAL BUSINESS | BD

| | |
|---|---|
| BUSINESS RESEARCHED | Aarong (a BRAC enterprise) — Bangladesh |
| RESEARCH TOPIC | How can Aarong grow online sales and brand love through social media and Meta Ads, without losing its heritage identity? |
| PREPARED BY | Shakir Hossain Talha |
| ROLE | Digital Marketing Manager \| Social Media Marketing Strategist |
| RESEARCH DATE | 01 January 2025 |

**INSIDE THIS CASE STUDY**

Market analysis | Customer psychology | Positioning | Meta Ads funnel | KPIs | 90-day roadmap

*Independent strategic research based on publicly observable brand activity. Not affiliated with or commissioned by the brand.*

# Executive Summary

Aarong is one of Bangladesh's most trusted lifestyle brands, built on handcrafted heritage and artisan livelihoods. The challenge for 2025 is not awareness; it is relevance. A younger, digital-first shopper compares Aarong with fast, trend-led fashion and a flood of Facebook boutiques, while the brand's real advantage (authenticity, craft, trust) is under-told on social media.

## THE 3 BIG INSIGHTS

### 01

**Heritage is the moat**

Competitors can copy a design in weeks. They cannot copy 40+ years of artisan relationships and cultural credibility. Story-led content turns that into a visible advantage.

### 02

**Moments drive revenue**

Demand spikes around Eid, Pohela Boishakh, Puja, weddings and winter. A seasonal, always-on-plus-burst plan beats flat monthly posting.

### 03

**Trust must be shown**

Online buyers worry about colour, fabric and fit. Proof content (real photos, size help, easy exchange) converts better than discount-only ads.

## WHAT THIS CASE STUDY COVERS

- Business snapshot, brand equity and a focused SWOT
- Competitor landscape across 4 segments and the white space Aarong can own
- Three customer personas with motivations, fears and buying triggers
- Positioning statement, message pillars and tone of voice
- Social media content system and a full-funnel Meta Ads structure
- Seasonal calendar, KPI framework and a 90-day action roadmap

### METHOD & NOTE ON DATA

Findings come from structured desk research: observing public social profiles, ad libraries, product ranges, customer comments and category behaviour. KPI figures in this document are planning benchmarks (assumptions to be validated in a test phase), not the company's internal data.

# Business Snapshot & Brand Equity

| Dimension | Summary |
|---|---|
| **Brand** | Aarong, retail enterprise of BRAC (launched 1978) |
| **Category** | Handcrafted lifestyle: ethnic and contemporary wear, home decor, gifts, accessories |
| **Core promise** | Authentic Bengali craft, quality you can trust, and purchases that support artisan livelihoods |
| **Channels** | Flagship and city outlets across Bangladesh, e-commerce, social commerce, messaging support |
| **Primary audience** | Women 22–45 (fashion and gifting), families, urban young professionals, diaspora gifters |
| **Digital goal (assumed)** | Increase online share of sales and grow loyal repeat buyers |

## FOUR BRAND EQUITY PILLARS

### Heritage & Craft

Block print, handloom, nakshi kantha and regional textiles give Aarong a story no mass brand can fake.

### Artisan Impact

Every purchase connects to rural craftspeople. Purpose is a powerful, emotional reason to choose.

### Quality Trust

Customers treat Aarong as the 'safe choice' for weddings, Eid and gifting, where mistakes are costly.

### Cultural Ownership

Pohela Boishakh, Eid and Puja are shopping rituals; Aarong is already part of the ritual.

## SWOT AT A GLANCE

### STRENGTHS

- Deep brand trust and heritage
- Strong in-house design and sourcing
- Wide product range for occasions

### WEAKNESSES

- Premium image can feel distant to Gen Z
- Social content may under-use artisan stories
- Online discovery vs. agile boutiques

### OPPORTUNITIES

- Short-form video storytelling
- Creator and micro-influencer partnerships
- Diaspora gifting campaigns

### THREATS

- Fast, trend-led fashion brands
- Low-price Facebook boutiques
- Rising ad costs in peak seasons

# Market & Competitor Landscape

Aarong competes in four different 'arenas' at the same time. Each arena fights for a different customer motivation, so the content and ad approach must change by arena.

| Arena | Examples | Their edge | Aarong's counter-position |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Mass fashion chains** | e.g. Yellow, Cats Eye, Ecstasy | Trend speed, price points, strong outlet reach | Craft-led, longer-lasting, culturally richer pieces |
| **Premium & designer boutiques** | e.g. Le Reve, independent designers | Exclusivity, designer names, wedding focus | Wider range with trusted quality at accessible price |
| **Facebook / F-commerce sellers** | Thousands of page-based boutiques | Low prices, fast replies, quick trends | Authenticity guarantee, consistent quality, easy exchange |
| **Marketplaces** | e.g. Daraz and similar | Convenience, deals, wide choice | Curated brand experience, gifting, heritage story |

## POSITIONING MAP: PRICE vs. AUTHENTICITY (conceptual)




**THE WHITE SPACE**

No competitor combines high craft authenticity with a trusted, accessible-premium brand and a purpose story. Aarong should own the position of 'the most trusted home of Bengali craft', and say it every week on social media.

# Who Buys & Why They Buy

People do not buy 'a kurta'. They buy confidence at a family event, belonging to a tradition, or the feeling of giving a meaningful gift. The three personas below guide messaging and targeting.

## The Festive Family Planner

WOMEN 30–45, URBAN/SEMI-URBAN

**MOTIVATION**
Wants everyone coordinated and well dressed for Eid and weddings without risk.

**FEAR / FRICTION**
Fear of wrong size, colour mismatch, late delivery.

**BUYING TRIGGER**
Early-season collection reveal, family look books, size guide, delivery date promise.

**BEST CHANNEL**
Facebook + Instagram carousels, WhatsApp support

## The Urban Young Professional

AGE 22–32, DIGITAL-FIRST

**MOTIVATION**
Wants culturally rooted style that still feels modern and 'Instagram-worthy'.

**FEAR / FRICTION**
Fear of looking 'too traditional' or paying for brand name only.

**BUYING TRIGGER**
Styling reels, fusion outfits, creator try-ons, 'wear it 3 ways' ideas.

**BEST CHANNEL**
Instagram Reels, TikTok-style short video

## The Diaspora Gifter

ABROAD, 28–55

**MOTIVATION**
Wants authentic gifts to send home or carry back; emotional connection to Bangladesh.

**FEAR / FRICTION**
Fear of poor quality or complicated shipping.

**BUYING TRIGGER**
Gift guides, packaging, artisan stories, simple international order flow.

**BEST CHANNEL**
Facebook, Instagram, email retargeting

### PSYCHOLOGICAL LEVERS TO USE

- Identity
- Social proof
- Purpose
- Seasonal urgency

# Positioning & Messaging

**POSITIONING STATEMENT**

*For style-conscious Bangladeshis who value authenticity, Aarong is the most trusted home of Bengali craft, where every piece carries a maker's story and fits modern life.*

## FOUR MESSAGE PILLARS

**1. Made by hands, made to last**

Show process: dyeing, weaving, block printing. Proof of craft.

**2. Wear your heritage, your way**

Modern styling of traditional pieces for young buyers.

**3. Every purchase has a maker**

Artisan faces and stories. Emotional, human, memorable.

**4. Right for every celebration**

Eid, Boishakh, Puja, wedding and gifting guides.

## TONE OF VOICE

**DO**

- Warm, proud, human
- Simple Bangla/English mix
- Story first, offer second
- Respectful and celebratory

**AVOID**

- Discount-only shouting
- Cold, corporate language
- Over-edited, unreal visuals
- Generic stock imagery

***Brand line suggestion for campaigns: "Heritage that fits today."***

## BRAND VOICE IN ACTION (sample captions)

**EID COLLECTION REVEAL REEL**

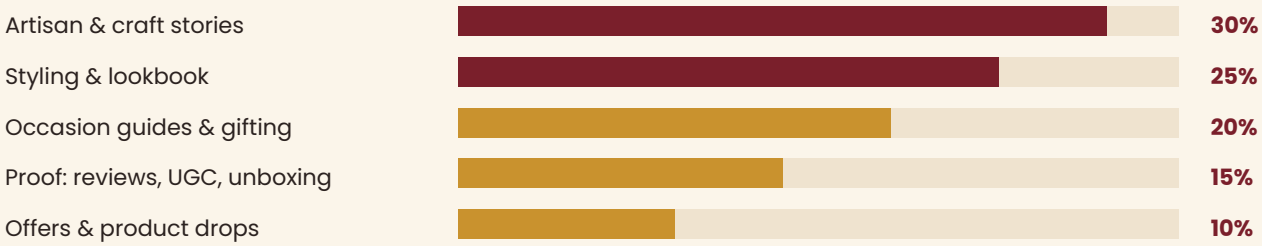
*Every thread has a maker. This Eid, meet the hands behind the collection you will wear, from the first loom to your celebration.*

**POHELA BOISHAKH STYLING CAROUSEL**

*One handloom saree, three ways to wear it. Tradition does not have to look the same on everyone.*

# Social Media & Meta Ads Funnel

## CONTENT MIX (suggested share of monthly output)




## FULL-FUNNEL META ADS STRUCTURE

| Stage | Objective | Audience | Creative | KPIs |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **TOP Awareness** | Reach / Video views | Broad women 22–45 BD; interest in ethnic wear, festivals; lookalike of buyers | Craft-story reels, collection reveals | CPM, 3-sec view rate, ThruPlay |
| **MIDDLE Consideration** | Traffic / Engagement | Video viewers 50%+, profile and page engagers, site visitors 30 days | Lookbooks, carousels, styling videos | CTR, CPC, landing page views |
| **BOTTOM Conversion** | Sales (catalog) | Add-to-cart & viewed content 14 days, cart abandoners | Dynamic product ads, reviews, delivery promise | CVR, CPA, ROAS |
| **LOYALTY Retention** | Sales / Messages | Past buyers 180 days, VIP list; seasonal pre-announce | New arrival early access, gift sets | Repeat rate, LTV |

## ROLE OF EACH PLATFORM

**Facebook**
Main sales and catalog engine; local community

**Instagram**
Brand story, Reels, lookbooks, creators

**YouTube / Shorts**
Festival films, artisan documentaries

**WhatsApp**
Order help, size advice, conversion

## WEEKLY CONTENT RHYTHM

| MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT | SUN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Artisan story | Styling reel | Product spotlight | Customer proof | Occasion guide | UGC & community | Behind the scenes |

**CREATIVE TESTING RULE**

Test one variable at a time (hook, format, offer or audience). Give each test enough budget and days to reach a reliable read before scaling the winner.

# Calendar, KPIs & 90-Day Roadmap

## 2025 SEASONAL MOMENTS (peak-demand windows)

| JAN | FEB | MAR | APR | MAY | JUN | JUL | AUG | SEP | OCT | NOV | DEC |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Dark = highest demand | Gold = medium | Beige = steady-state. Peaks: Mar–Apr (Eid-ul-Fitr, Pohela Boishakh), Jun (Eid-ul-Adha), Oct–Dec (Puja, weddings, winter).

## KPI FRAMEWORK (planning benchmarks to validate)

| Goal | Metrics tracked | Target direction (benchmark) |
|---|---|---|
| **Awareness** | CPM, reach, 3-sec video view rate | Stable CPM; rising video view rate month on month |
| **Engagement** | CTR (link), saves, shares, comments | Link CTR target 1.0–1.8% on cold audiences |
| **Conversion** | CVR, cost per purchase, add-to-cart rate | Landing CVR improvement through proof and size help |
| **Profitability** | ROAS vs. break-even ROAS, AOV | ROAS above break-even by month 3 on retargeting |
| **Loyalty** | Repeat purchase rate, LTV | Grow repeat buyers via seasonal pre-access offers |

## 90-DAY ROADMAP

### DAYS 1–30
### Foundation

- Audit social profiles, pixel and catalog
- Define personas and audience lists
- Create 12 hero creatives + story bank
- Launch awareness test (3 audiences)

### DAYS 31–60
### Test & Learn

- A/B test hooks, formats, offers
- Scale winning video creatives
- Start retargeting funnel
- Weekly report: CTR, CPA, ROAS

### DAYS 61–90
### Scale & Retain

- Scale budgets on proven ad sets
- Creator and UGC programme
- Loyalty / early-access audience
- Quarter review and next-quarter plan

## REPORTING RHYTHM

**DAILY**
Spend, delivery and CPA alerts

**WEEKLY**
Creative review and scaling decisions

**MONTHLY**
ROAS, LTV and strategy reset

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*This case study shows how I approach every brand: research the market, understand the customer's psychology, sharpen the positioning, then turn it into measurable social media and Meta Ads performance.*

**Market Research** **Customer Psychology** **Brand Positioning** **Meta Ads Funnel**

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Signature

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**01 January 2025**

Date of research

*Independent strategic research on publicly observable brand activity. KPI figures are planning benchmarks, not company data.*